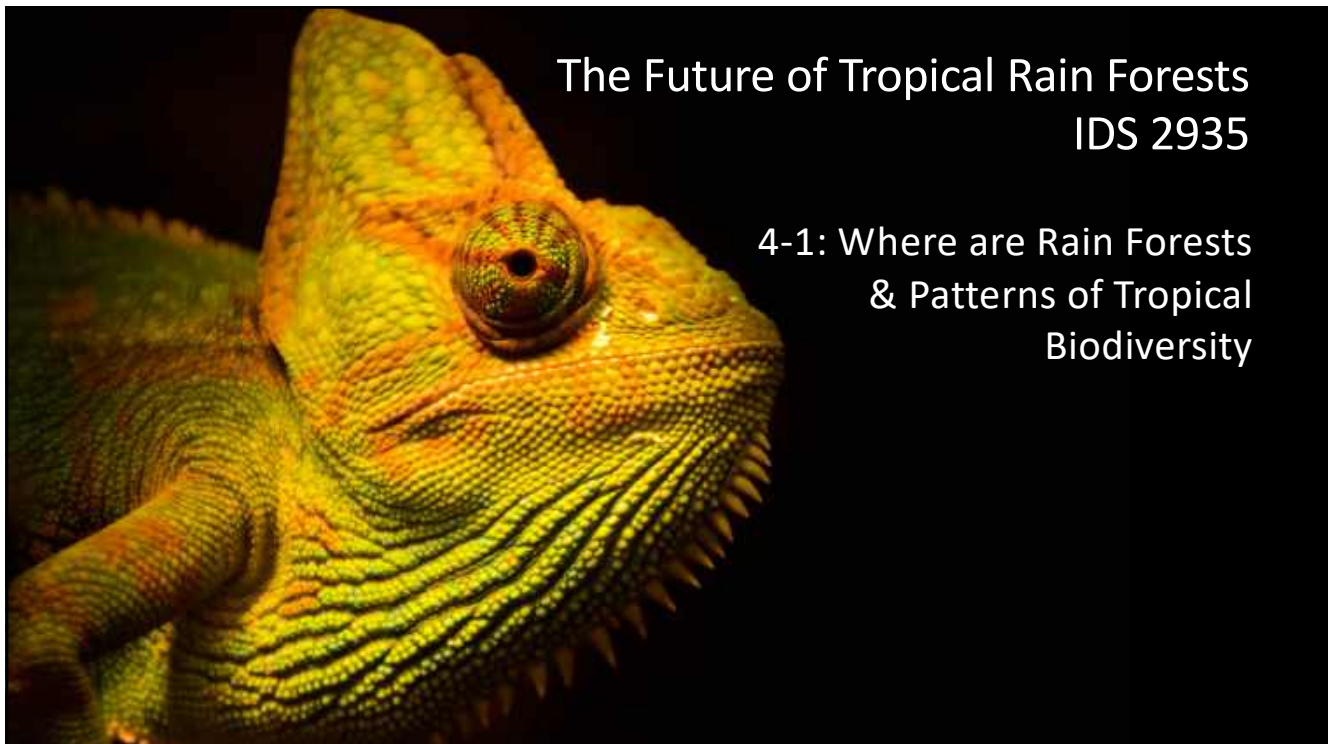
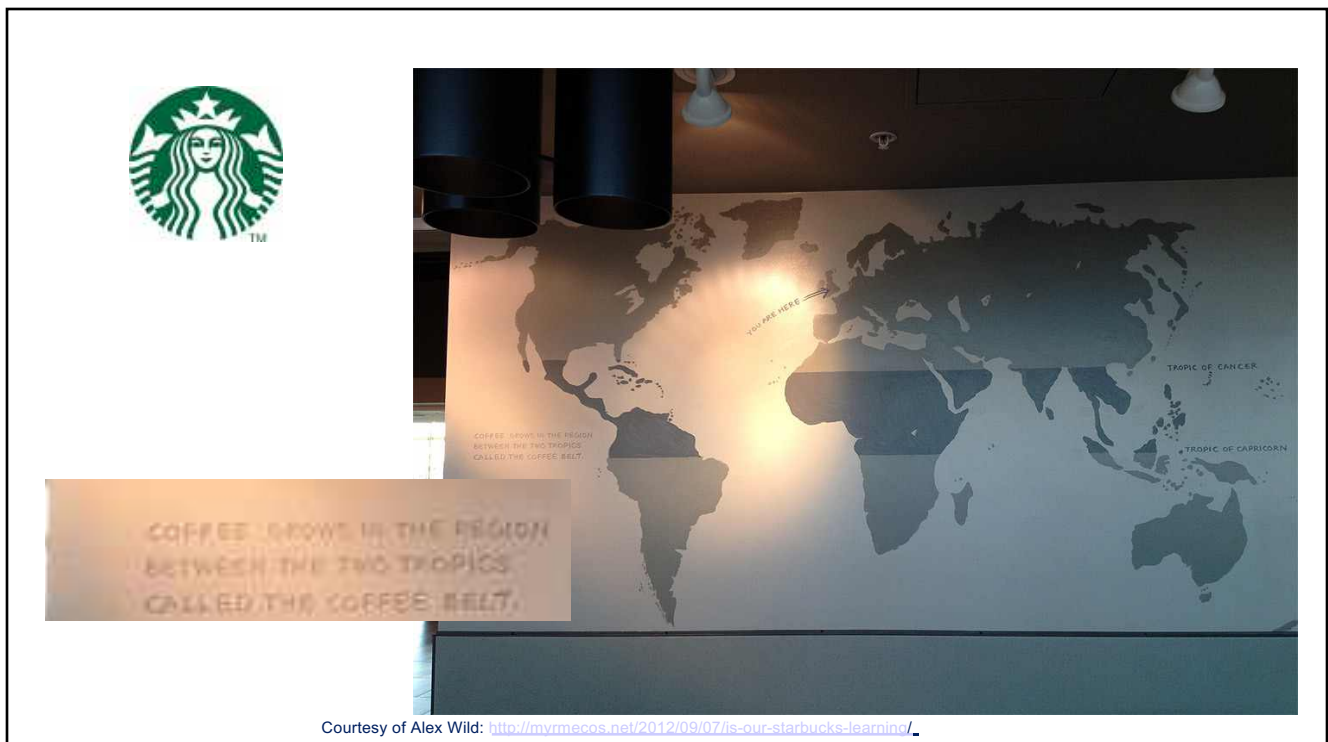




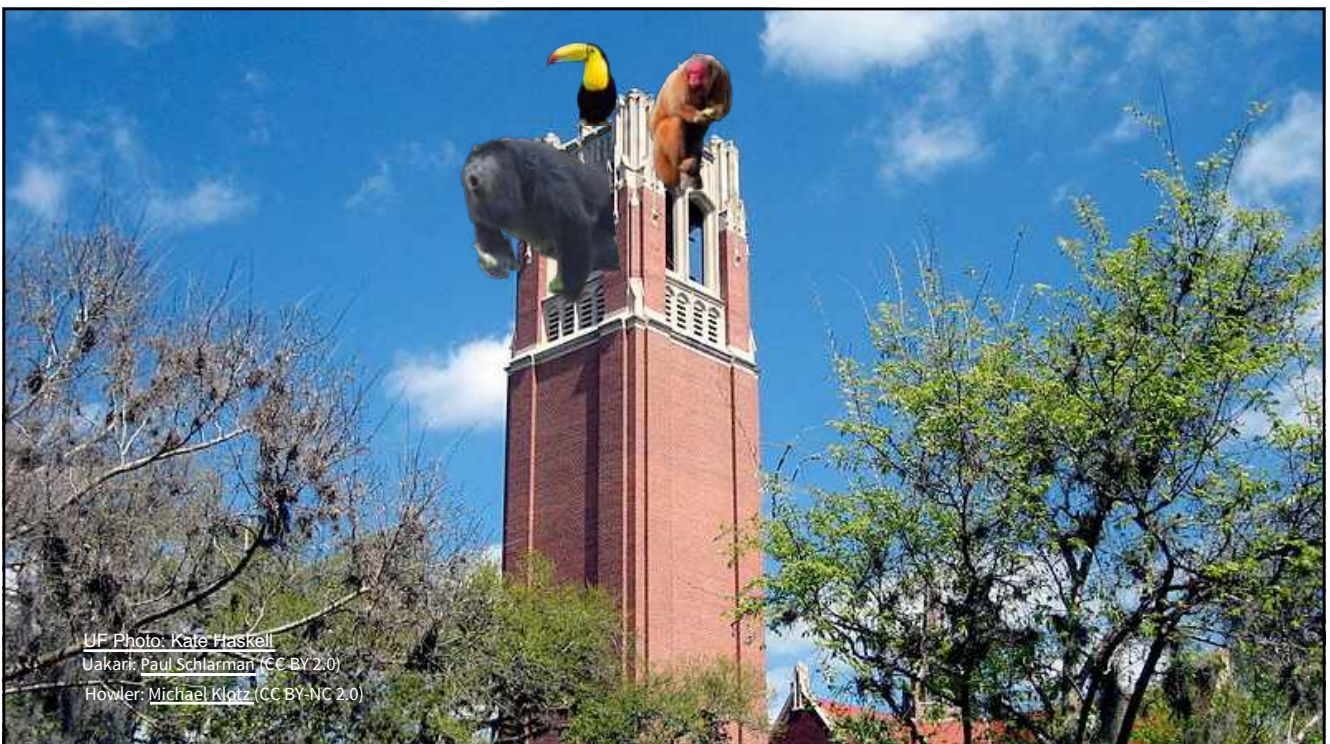
1



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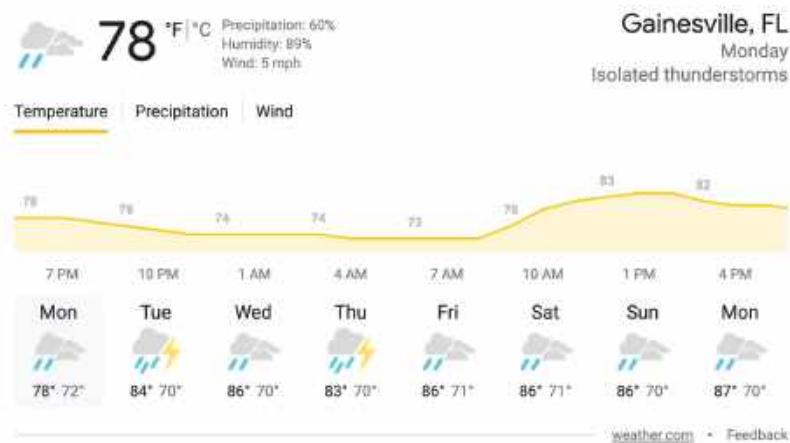
WHERE



7

Weather vs. Climate

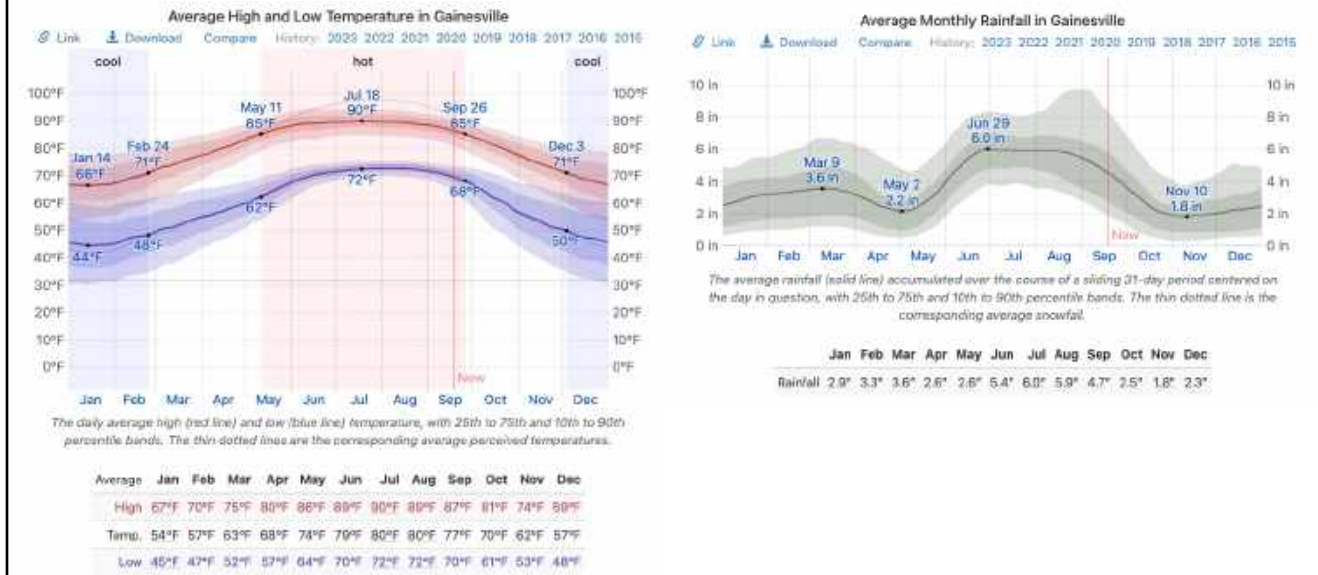
Weather: present conditions at a site (and short-term variation in these conditions)



8

Weather vs. Climate

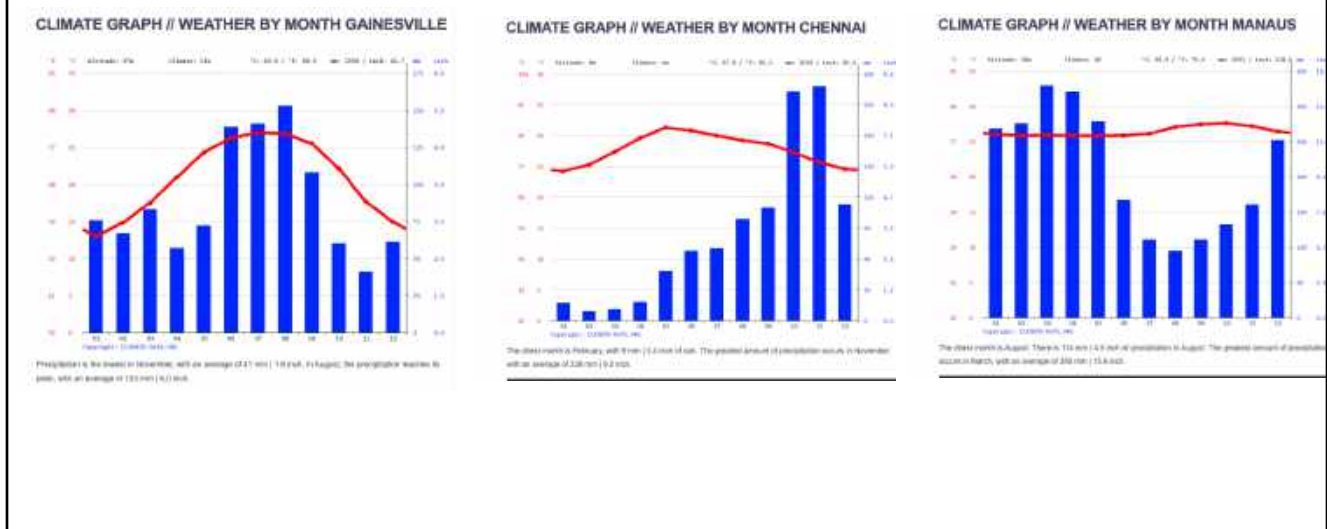
Climate: avg. conditions in a location over longer time scales (e.g., 30 yr. avg.)



9

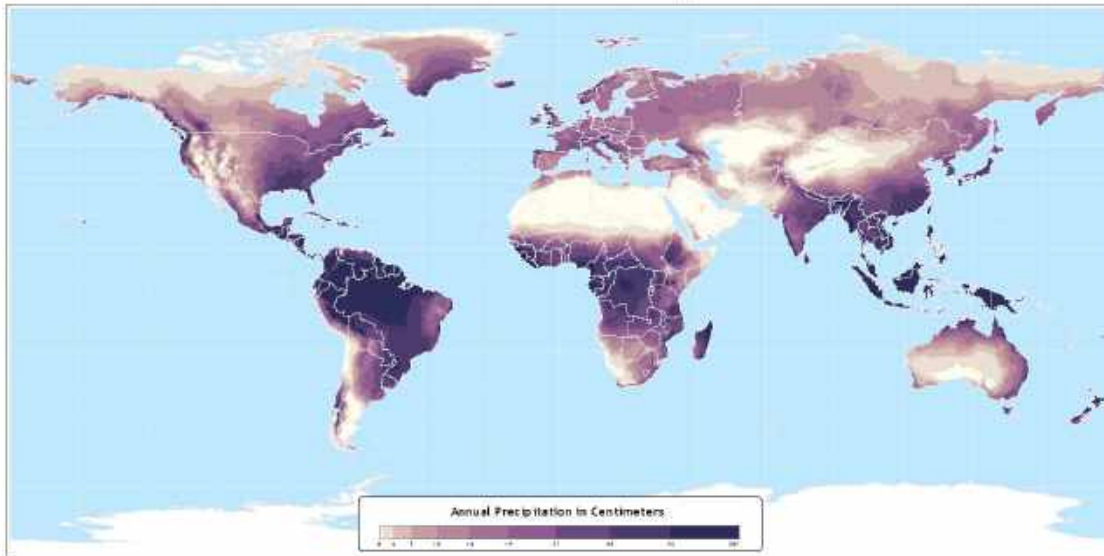
Weather vs. Climate

Climate: avg. conditions in a location over longer time scales (e.g., 30 yr. avg.)



10

Annual Total Precipitation

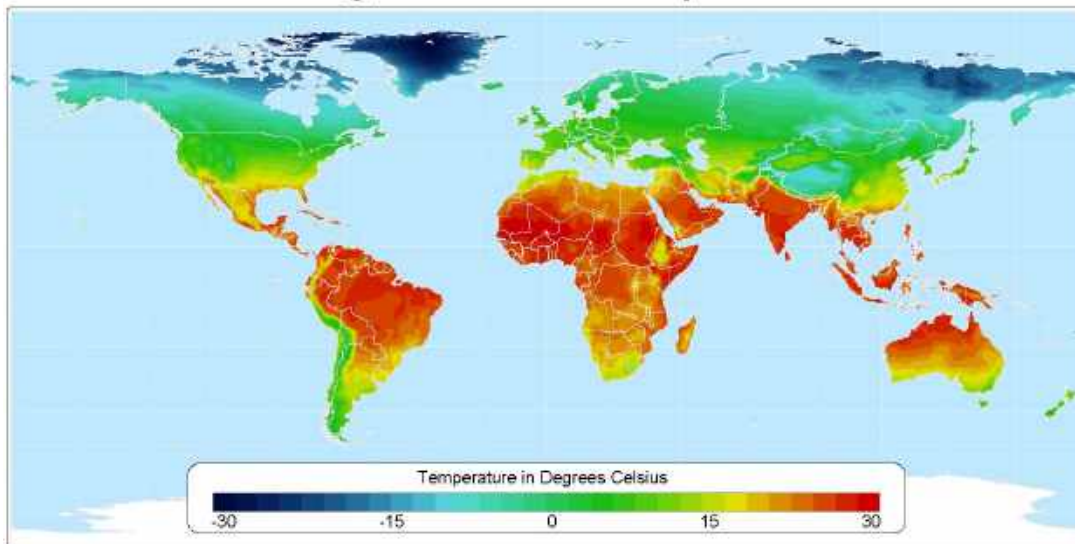


Data taken from: CRU 0.5 Degree Dataset (New et al.)

Atlas of the Biosphere
Center for Sustainability and the Global Environment
University of Wisconsin - Madison

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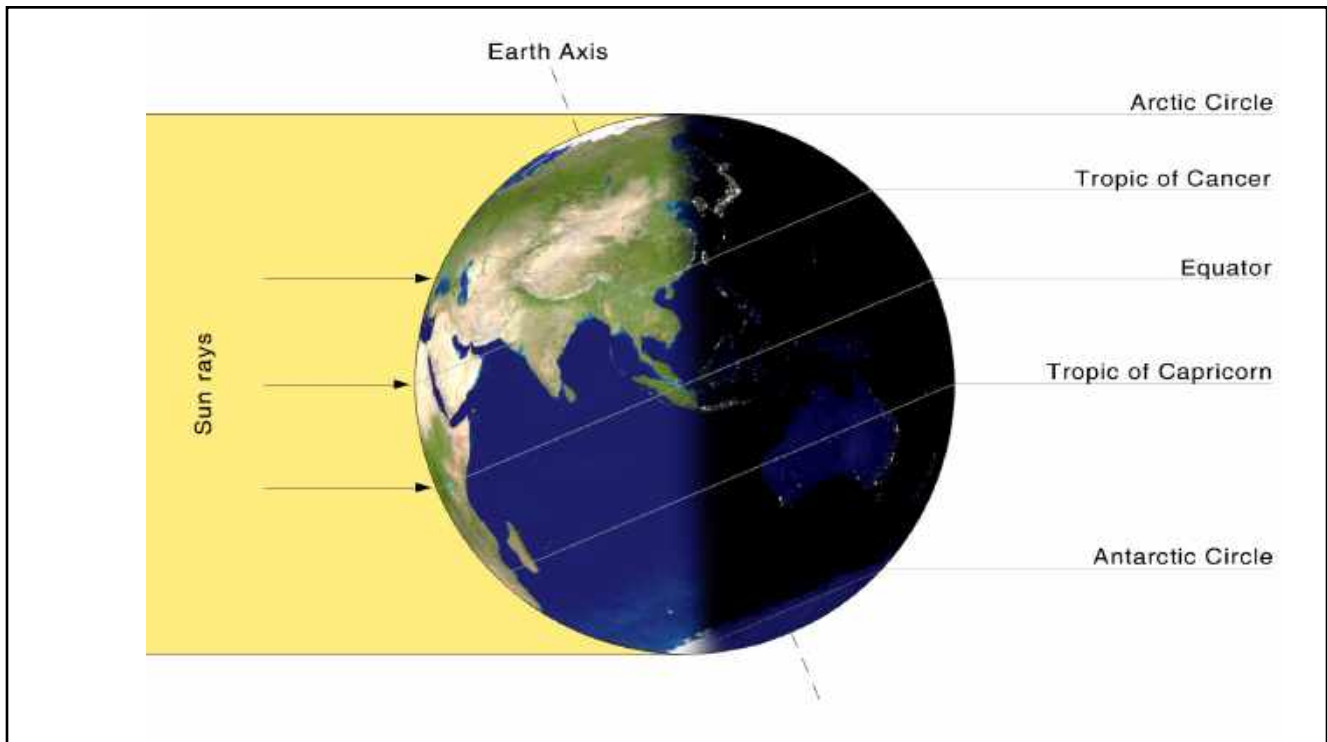
Average Annual Temperature



Data taken from: CRU 0.5 Degree Dataset (New, et al.)

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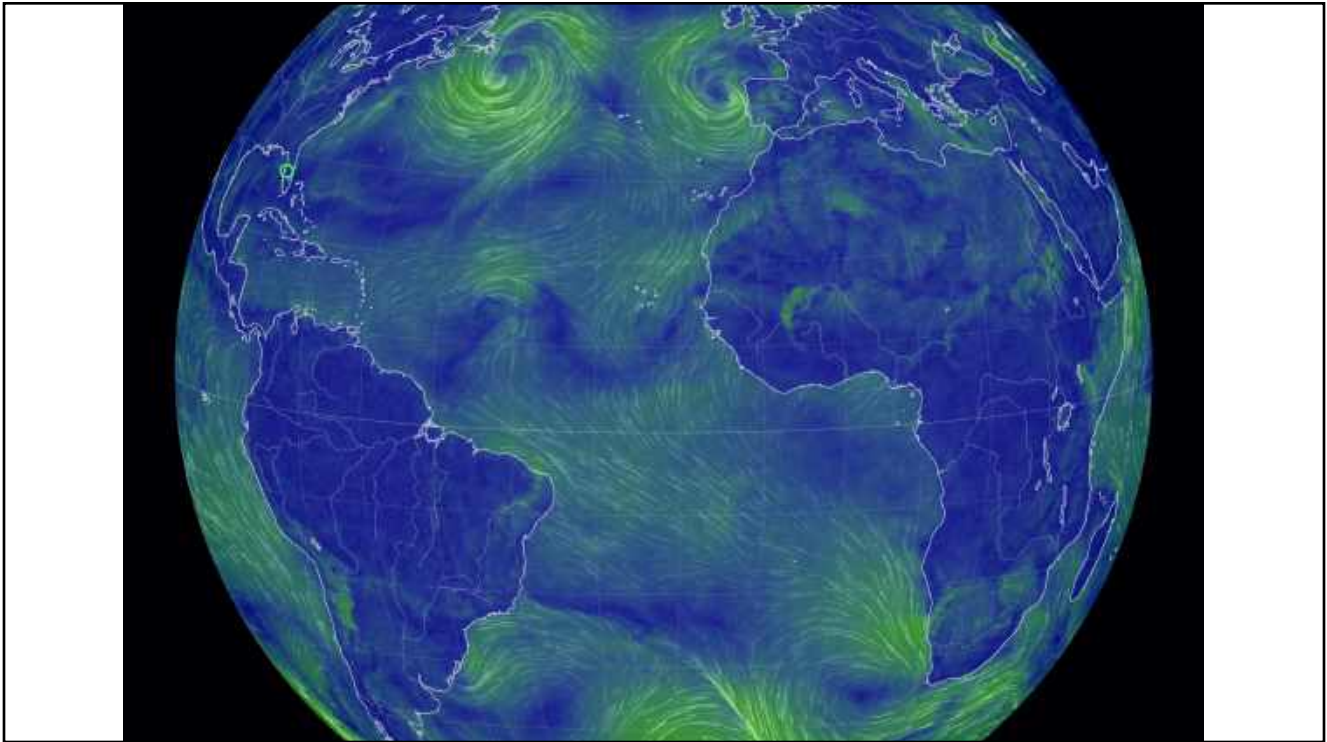
13

If lots of other places are hot or rainy, why are the world's rain forests found here?

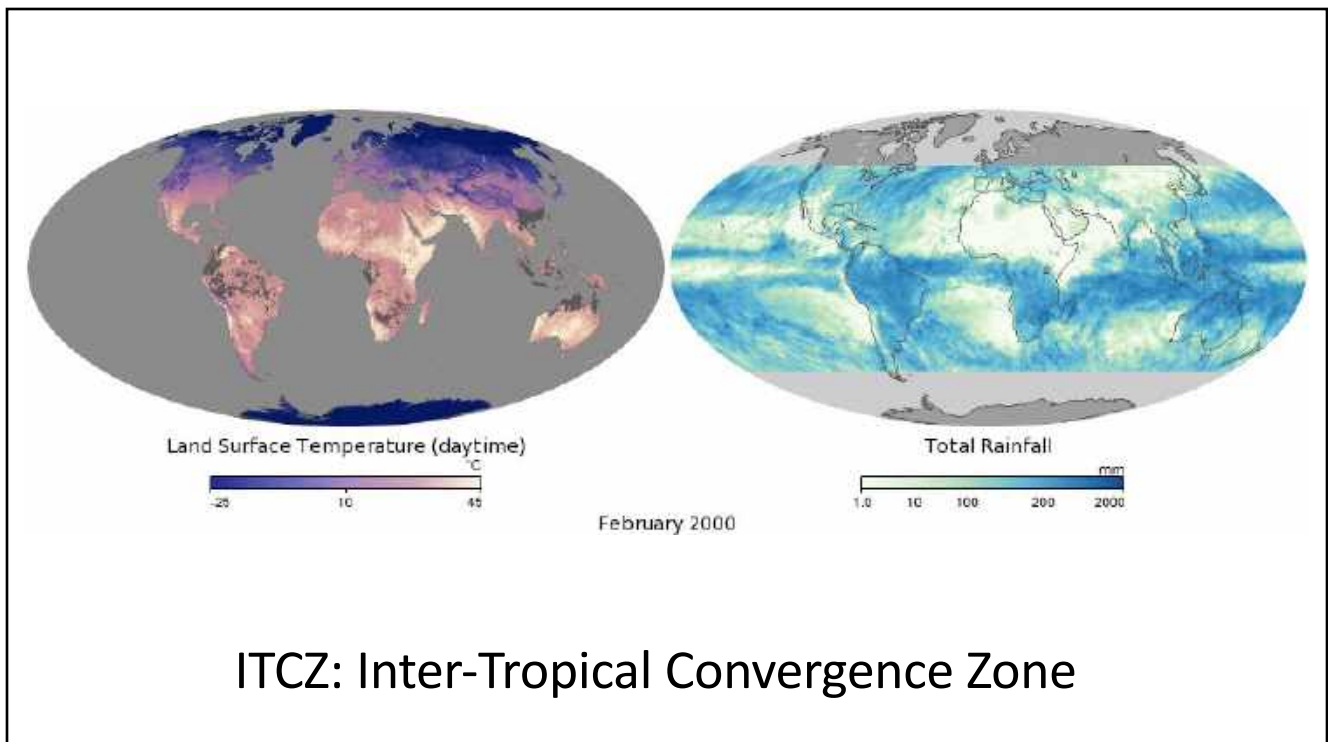


Put another way, what limits their distribution?

14



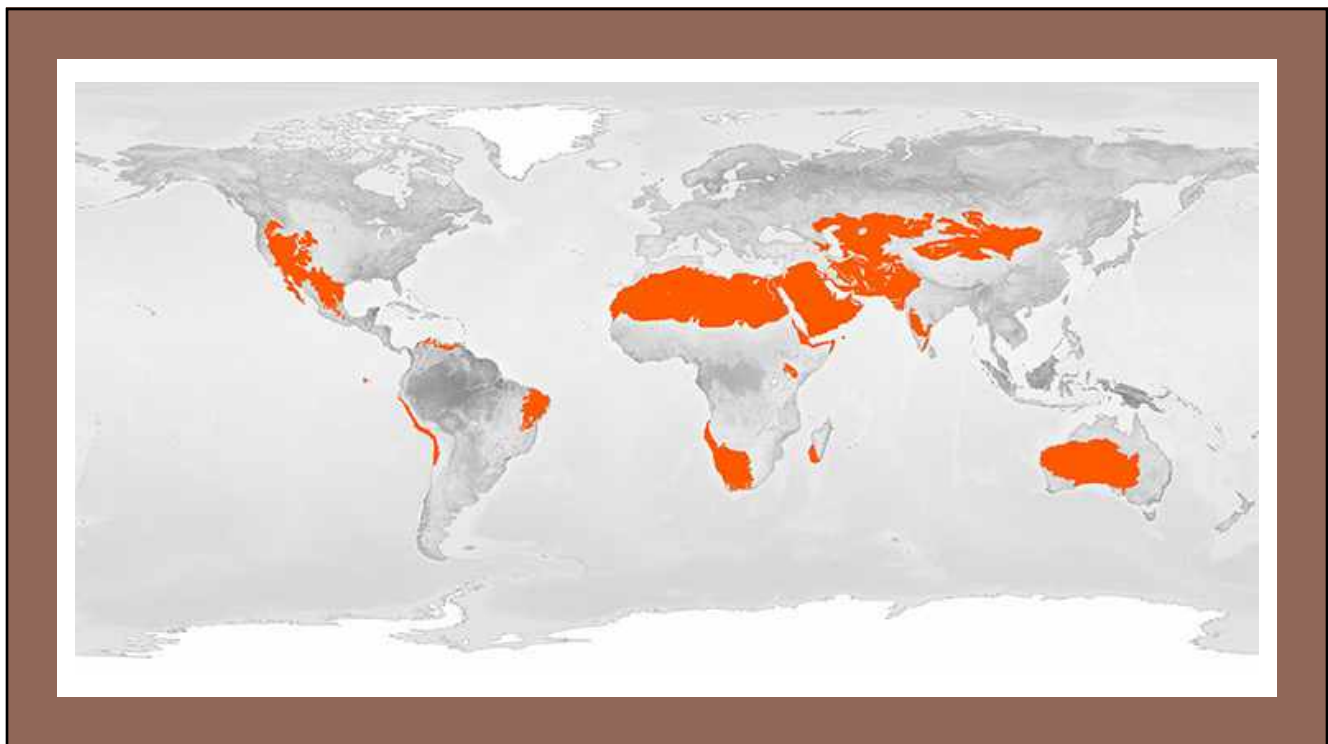
15



16



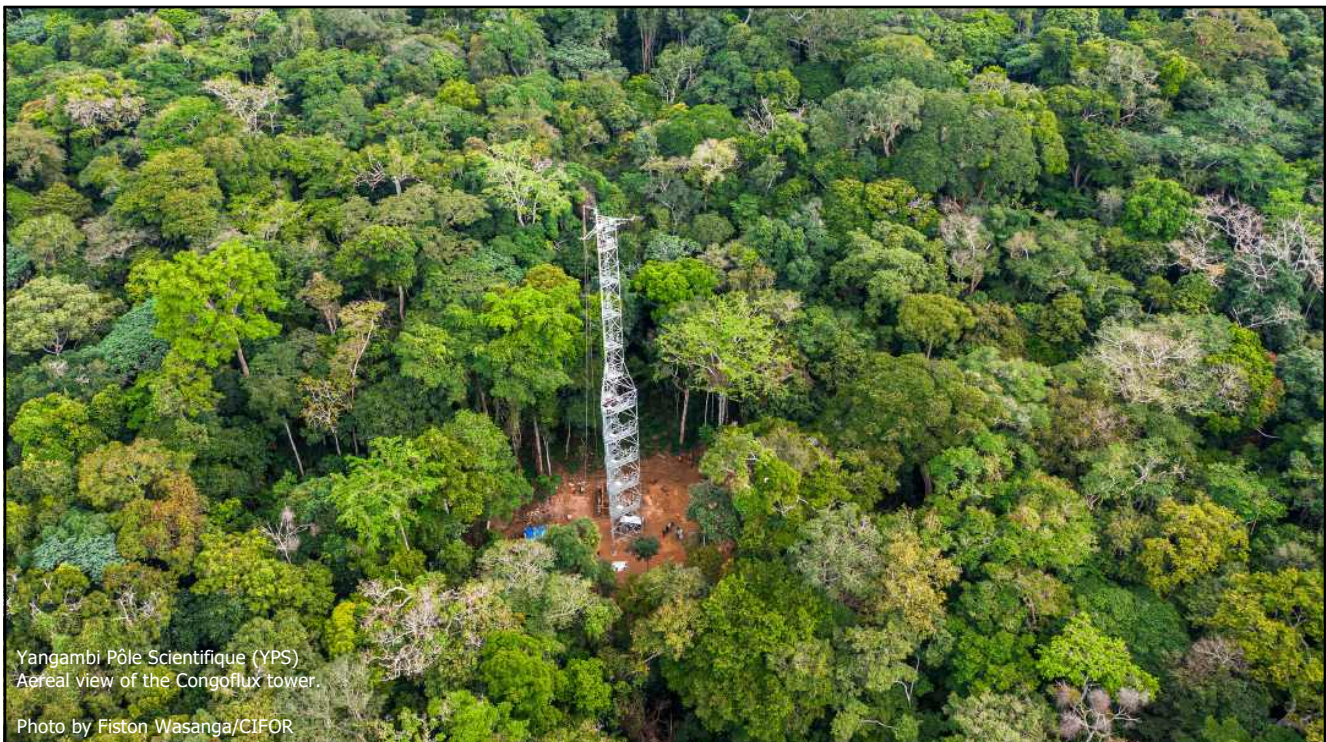
17



18



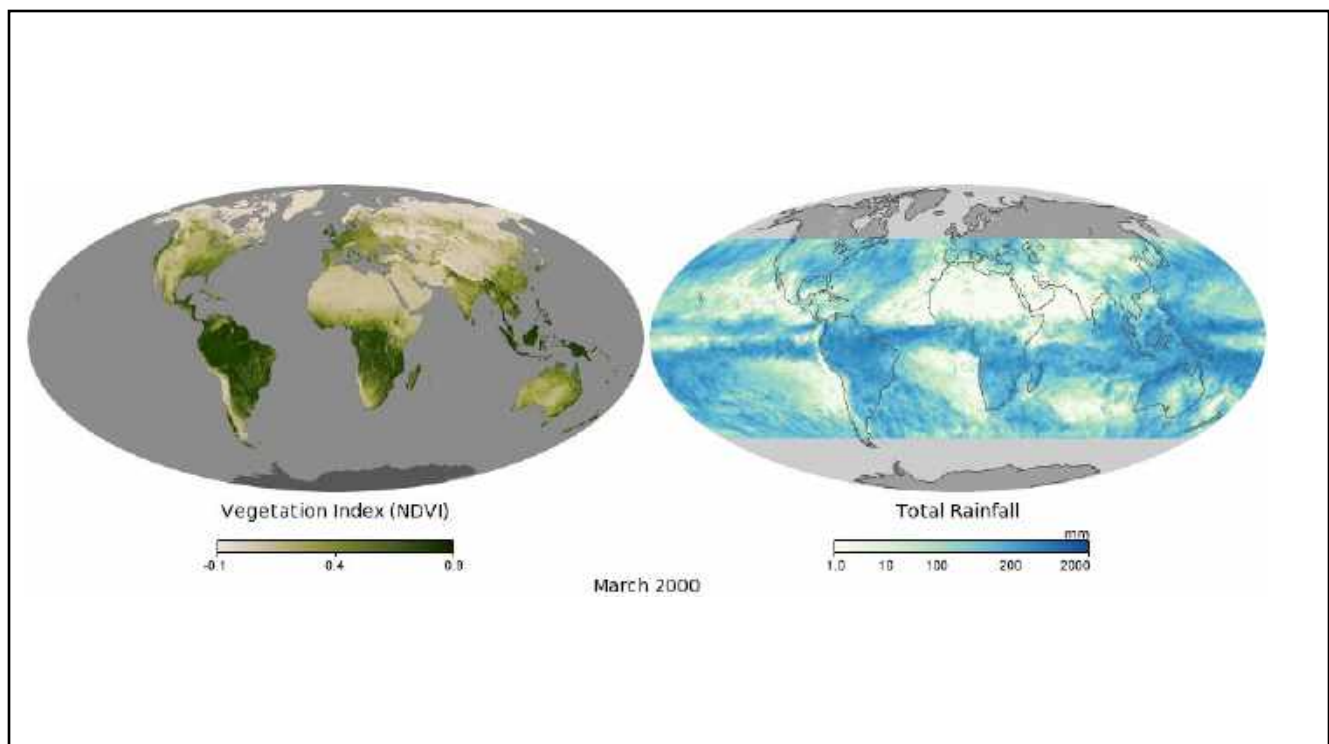
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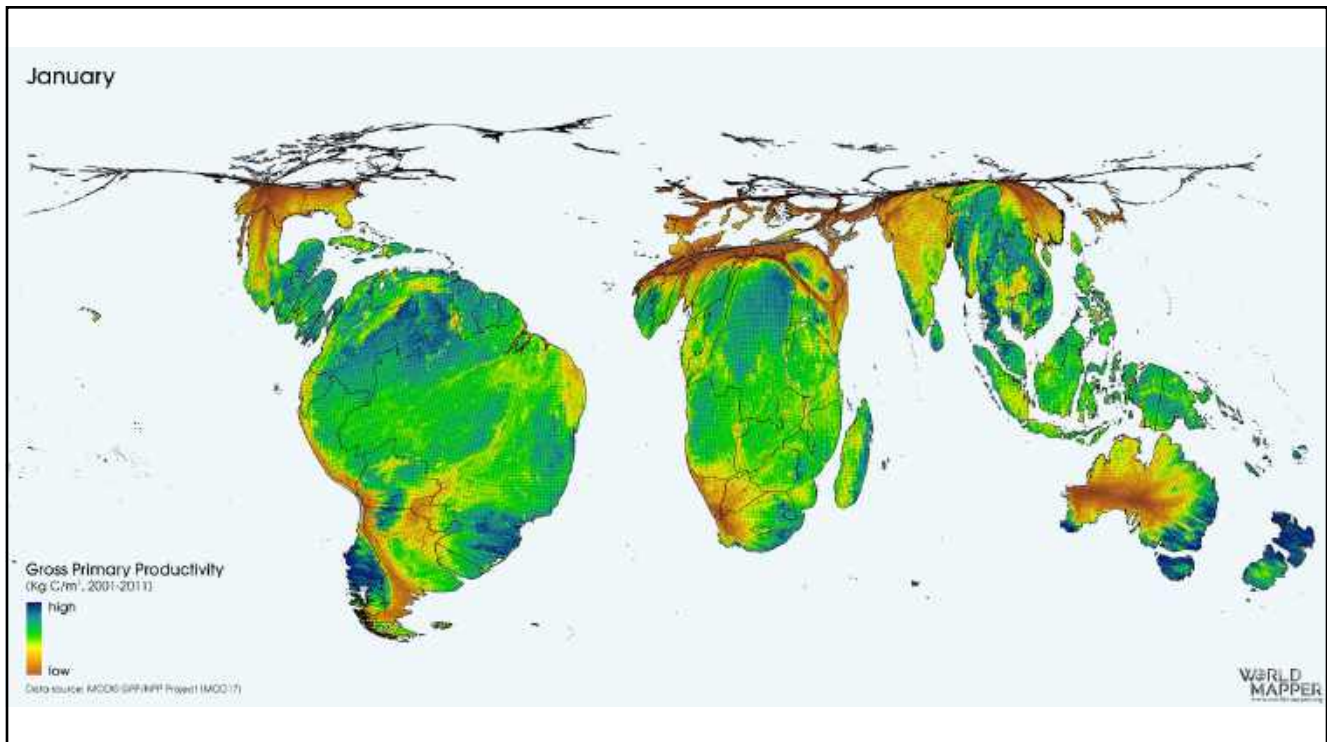
20



21



22



23

How much rain forest is there in the world?

1.84 billion hectares

18.4 million km²

132.48 Floridas

2.27x the Continental USA



24

12% of Earth's land
surface

50% of Terrestrial
Biodiversity

25



26